

An initiative must become something

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

The initiative means your threats make the opponent respond. It often rests on temporary activity or development. Use it to gain material, improve the structure, achieve a lasting restriction, or build a decisive attack before the opponent coordinates.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A lead in development may justify opening the center while the enemy king remains there. If you spend several tempi on unrelated pawn moves, the opponent may castle and erase the reason your attack was promising.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you ask while you have the initiative?

ANSWER AND REASONING

What concrete asset can this pressure produce, and how much time remains before the opponent neutralizes it? Calculate the transition rather than attacking for its own sake.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Convert temporary time into a durable gain.